

RISK vs. REWARD – Full Format Bible

How much would you bet you're right?

1-Hour Studio Game Show

Players: Solo Contestants or Couples

Prize Range: \$0.01 to \$1,000,000

LOGLINE

Contestants answer trivia questions—but before locking in an answer, they must decide how much they trust their choice. That decision determines how much they can win or lose and permanently shapes their path to a \$1,000,000 prize.

CORE PREMISE

RISK vs. REWARD is a trivia game built around one idea:

Confidence is currency.

After seeing a question and its possible answers, contestants must decide how much they believe in their choice. That decision is not just a wager—it reshapes their entire financial trajectory through the game.

GAME STRUCTURE

- 12-question single-contestant game (studio-based)
- Contestants choose a category before each question
- Each question is multiple choice (4 answers)
- Contestants answer first, then set confidence via slider
- Outcomes are revealed immediately after lock-in
- One “Do Over” lifeline available (Questions 1–6 only)

CORE GAME LOOP (EVERY QUESTION)

Each question follows this sequence:

1. Contestant selects category
2. Question + 4 answers are revealed
3. Contestant selects an answer
4. Contestant sets confidence using a dynamic slider
5. Contestant locks in
6. Result is revealed
7. Bank + future earning potential update

BANK SYSTEM

Each contestant begins with a starting bank that serves as the foundation for all future gains and losses.

The bank represents the contestant's current accumulated value in the game.

The bank:

- increases with correct answers
- decreases with incorrect answers
- and is influenced by confidence decisions over time

However, unlike traditional trivia formats, the bank is only part of the system. The contestant's **future earning potential (ceiling)** is equally important.

CONFIDENCE SLIDER (CORE MECHANIC)

Before locking in each answer, contestants use a real-time slider to set confidence.

They see:

- potential winnings if correct
- potential loss if incorrect
- current bank impact
- and updated possible final winnings range

The slider is continuous rather than divided into fixed confidence tiers.

Instead:

contestants react to changing dollar values in real time.

RISK / REWARD BEHAVIOR

The slider determines:

High Confidence (far right)

- higher possible winnings
- higher possible losses
- preserves access to maximum prize path (\$1,000,000)

Low Confidence (left side)

- lower immediate exposure
- lower winnings potential (down to near zero)
- permanently reduces future earning potential

NON-LINEAR VALUE CURVE

Risk and reward do not scale linearly.

The underlying value curve encourages decisive play while still allowing contestants to protect themselves when uncertain.

CEILING SYSTEM (KEY INNOVATION)

At all times, contestants have a visible range of possible final outcomes:

- **Least you can win**
- **Most you can win**

These values:

- are displayed continuously during gameplay
- range shrinks as the game progresses
- are not required on the final question (where bank + risk/reward determine outcome directly)

IMPORTANT RULE:

Incorrect answers permanently reduce the contestant's maximum possible winning ceiling.

Example:

- A contestant playing maximum confidence throughout can reach \$1,000,000
- A first-question miss at max confidence reduces their ceiling to approximately \$215,000
- That \$1,000,000 maximum cannot be restored later in the game

This creates permanent consequence-based progression.

THE \$1,000,000 PATH

The \$1,000,000 outcome is:

- available at the start of the game
- maintained through high-confidence correct play
- and lost permanently through certain incorrect outcomes

It is not guaranteed and must be preserved through strategic decisions.

DO OVER LIFELINE

Each contestant has one Do Over lifeline, usable only during Questions 1–6.

Function:

- Cancels the current question and its result
- Replaces it with a new question
- Provides a second attempt opportunity

Strategic Purpose:

Most valuable when a high-confidence mistake would significantly reduce future earning potential.

END GAME

After 12 questions, contestants leave with the final value of their bank, reflecting every confidence decision made throughout the game.

There is no elimination and no ranking—only final earned outcome.

WHY IT WORKS

RISK vs. REWARD transforms trivia into:

a psychological test of confidence under financial pressure

Key viewer hooks:

- Every decision changes future possibilities
- Viewers constantly judge their own confidence vs contestants
- Early mistakes have visible long-term consequences
- Real-time dollar shifts make risk immediately understandable
- Multiple outcome tiers create constant tension
- Couples mode adds relational conflict and negotiation

At its core:

It is not about knowing answers—it is about deciding how much you trust your own answers when money is on the line.

PLAY THE DEMO

A fully functional interactive prototype demonstrates the complete game system in real time, including category selection, question flow, dynamic confidence slider, and full trajectory simulation.

 <https://eddielawhorn.com/risk-vs-reward/game>

TAGLINE

Knowing the answer is only half the game.
Knowing how much to trust it wins the money.

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